Make sure to set the following variables in your `.env` file:

```
DB_CONNECTION=sqlite
```

11.8.4.3 Step 3: Create a Migration for `employees`

We will create a migration for the `employees` table. This table will store information about employees.

Create the migration:

```
php artisan make:migration create_employees_table
```

This will create a new migration file in the `database/migrations` directory. Open the newly created migration file and modify it to create the `employees` table. The file will be named something like `xxxx_xx_xx_xxxxxx_create_employees_table.php`. Open the migration file and modify it:

```
Schema::create('employees', function (Blueprint $table) {
    $table->id();
    $table->string('name');
    $table->decimal('salary', 10, 2);
    $table->integer('years_of_service');
    $table->timestamps();
});
```

Save the file and run the migration to create the `employees` table:

```
php artisan migrate
```

You can verify that the table has been created by checking the database file or using a database management tool.

11.8.4.4 Step 4:Seed the Database

We will create a seeder for the `employees` table to populate it with sample data.

Create the seeder:

```
php artisan make:seeder EmployeeSeeder
```

This will create a new seeder file in the `database/seeders` directory. Open the newly created file and add the following code to seed the `employees` table.

Edit `database/seeders/EmployeeSeeder.php`: